

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Lesson 4: Classification and Evaluation Metrics

Technologies for Artificial Intelligence

Fabio Antonini, Università degli Studi dell'Aquila

30 October 2026

Before we start

- Exercise 3, which we discuss now
- Ridge, Lasso, and the choice of the penalty strength

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Today: from a number to a decision

- Logistic regression: the model and why the cost had to change
- The confusion matrix, and why accuracy lies
- Precision, recall, F1, and the threshold nobody chose
- Receiver operating characteristic (ROC) curves, and where they mislead
- Choosing a threshold from money

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The question has changed

- Lesson 3: given a house, **how many euros?**
- Lesson 4: given a disk drive, **will it fail?**
- Answer with a probability: $0 \leq P(y = 1 \mid x) \leq 1$
- $y = 1$ if the drive failed, $y = 0$ if not; x holds its six counters

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The fleet

- **8,000 disk drives** in a data centre
- Six SMART counters each: Self-Monitoring, Analysis and Reporting Technology
- Reallocated sectors, spin retries, read and seek error rates, temperature, hours in service
- Label: did it fail within thirty days?
- `train_test_split(..., stratify=y)`: 6,000 to train, 2,000 to test

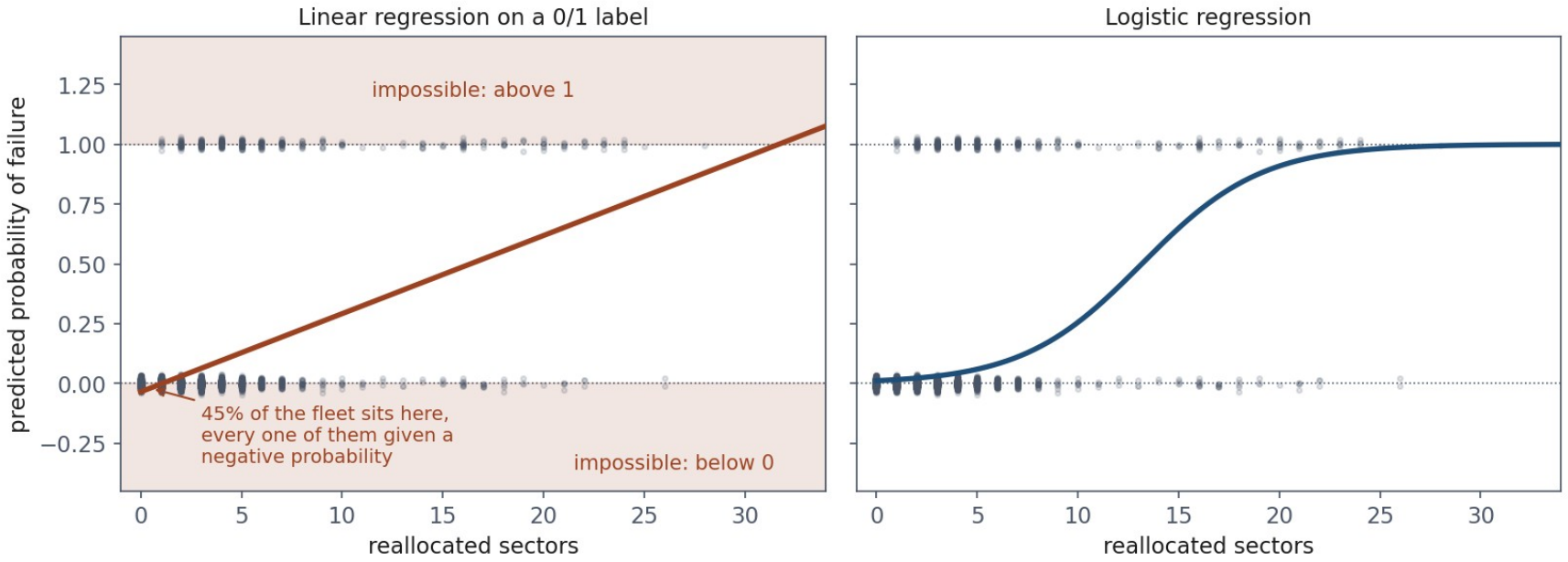
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

306

- **306 of the 8,000 drives failed**: 306 ÷ 8,000 = 3.8% of the fleet
- Which means 100% − 3.8% = 96.2% did not

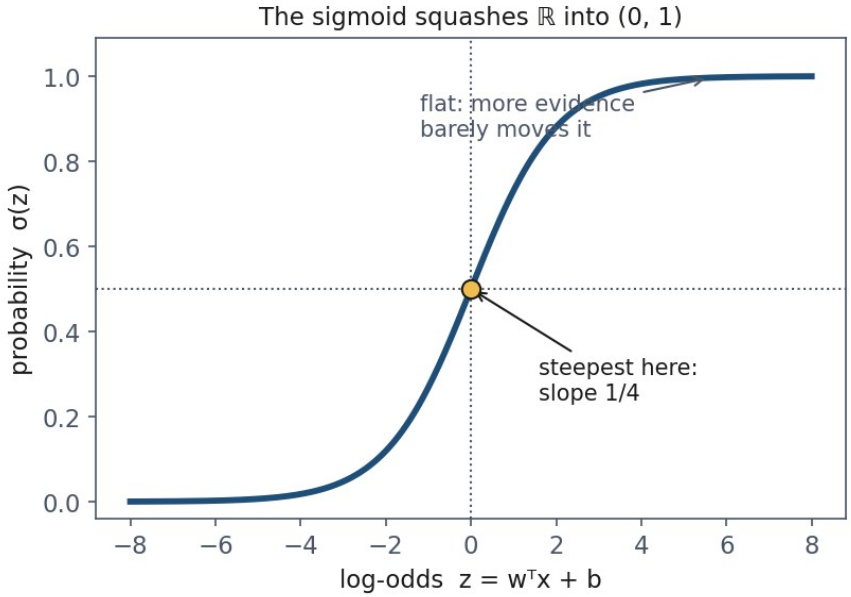
UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

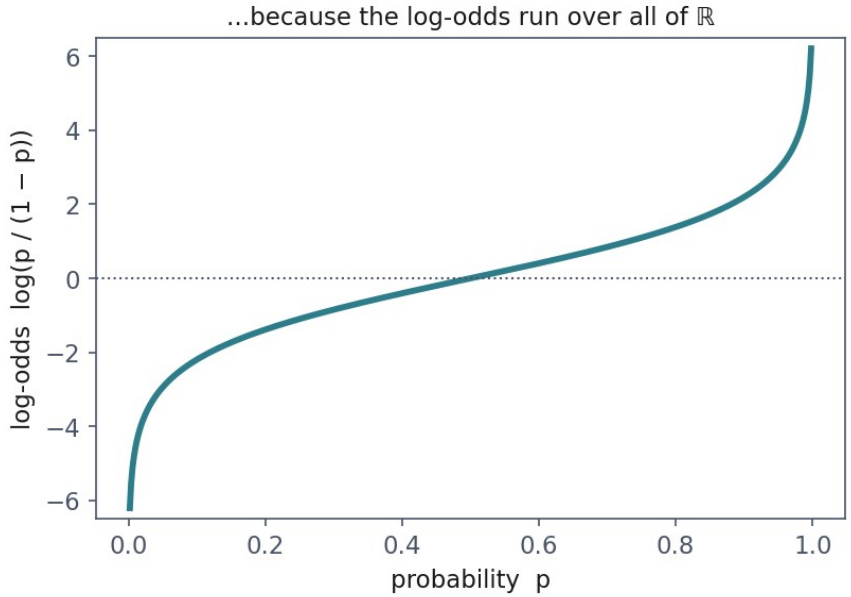
What goes wrong if we just fit a line



UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

The sigmoid





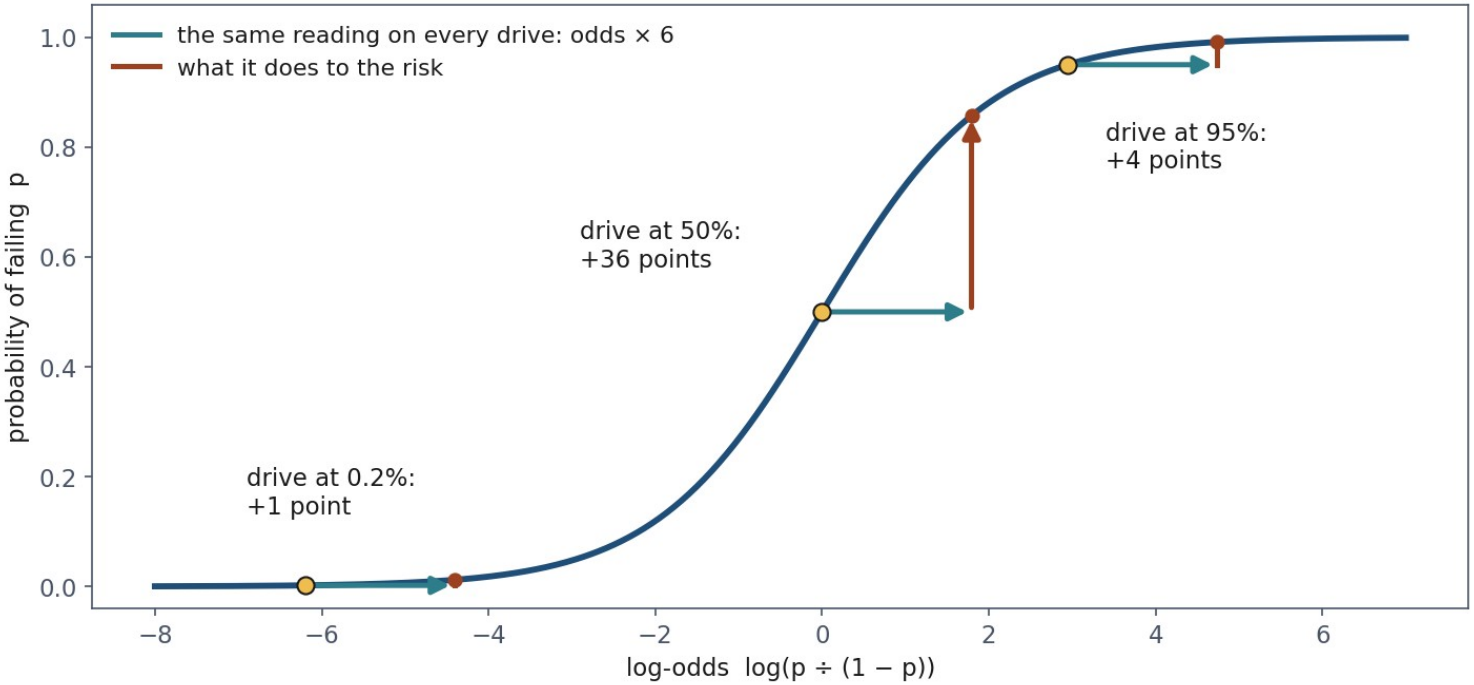
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Why the log-odds

- A line gives any number; a probability, only [0, 1]
- Odds, $p \div (1 - p)$: no ceiling, from 0 to ∞
- Log of the odds: no floor either, $-\infty$ to $+\infty$
- $p = 0.99$: $\log(0.99 \div 0.01) = \log 99 = +4.60$; $p = 0.5$: $\log(0.5 \div 0.5) = \log 1 = 0$
- Bonus: coefficients multiply the odds (slide 13)

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Evidence multiplies the odds



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Log-odds of p = P(y = 1 | x): a line

$$\log \frac{p}{1-p} = w^\top x + b \quad \Longrightarrow \quad p = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-(w^\top x + b)}}$$

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

The model, in one line

$$P(y = 1 \mid x) = \sigma(w^\top x + b), \qquad \sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

What the coefficients mean

- Standardised: one standard deviation more of reallocated sectors adds 1.80 to the log-odds
- Adding to a log multiplies the **odds**: log(odds) + 1.80 = log(odds × 6.05), since exp(1.80) = 6.05
- So: **six times the odds** of failing, slide 10’s teal step
- In code: `make_pipeline(StandardScaler(), LogisticRegression())`

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL’AQUILA

The truth, and what we recovered

Feature	True	Fitted, notebook 1	Odds ×, exp(Fitted)
reallocated_sectors	1.80	1.66	5.28
spin_retry_count	1.15	1.17	3.22
read_error_rate	0.85	0.87	2.39
temperature_c	0.45	0.47	1.59
power_on_hours	0.35	0.38	1.46
seek_error_rate	**0.00**	**0.02**	**1.03**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The intercept is the average drive’s chance

- Fitted intercept: **−6.09**, the log-odds of a drive average on every counter (all x = 0)
- $\sigma(-6.09) = 1 \div (1 + \exp(6.09)) = 1 \div 442 = 0.0023$: a 0.2% chance
- The fleet fails at 3.8% (slide 6): the failures come from the few drives far above average

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Fitting means minimising something, but what?

- Squared error worked for lesson 3
- Why not just apply it to the sigmoid’s output?

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Step 1: each drive gets a p

Drive	What happened	y	Setting 1: $p = \sigma(w^T x + b)$, the P(fail)
A	failed	1	0.8
B	stayed healthy	0	0.1
C	stayed healthy	0	0.2

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Step 2: how likely was the outcome?

Drive	y	p	Probability of what happened: p if y = 1, 1 - p if y = 0
A	1	0.8	0.8
B	0	0.1	$1 - 0.1 = 0.9$
C	0	0.2	$1 - 0.2 = 0.8$
All three: multiply			$0.8 \times 0.9 \times 0.8 =$ **0.576**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Step 2 as formulas: the likelihood

$$P(y \mid x) = p^{\,y}\,(1-p)^{1-y}$$

$$\mathcal{L}(w,b) = \prod_{i=1}^{m} \left(p^{(i)}\right)^{y^{(i)}} \left(1-p^{(i)}\right)^{1-y^{(i)}}$$

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Step 3: two settings, the likelier wins

Drive	y	Setting 1: p	Setting 1: probability of what happened	Setting 2: p	Setting 2: probability of what happened
A	1	0.8	0.8	0.3	0.3
B	0	0.1	$1 - 0.1 = 0.9$	0.6	$1 - 0.6 = 0.4$
C	0	0.2	$1 - 0.2 = 0.8$	0.5	$1 - 0.5 = 0.5$
Likelihood: the product			$0.8 \times 0.9 \times 0.8 =$ **0.576**		$0.3 \times 0.4 \times 0.5 =$ **0.060**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Step 4: minus the log, a cost

Drive	y	Setting 1: −log of probability of what happened	Setting 2: −log of probability of what happened
A	1	−log 0.8 = 0.22	−log 0.3 = 1.20
B	0	−log 0.9 = 0.11	−log 0.4 = 0.92
C	0	−log 0.8 = 0.22	−log 0.5 = 0.69
Sum = −log of the likelihood		0.22 + 0.11 + 0.22 = **0.55**	1.20 + 0.92 + 0.69 = **2.81**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Cross-entropy, also called log loss

$$L = -[\, y \log p + (1-y) \log(1-p)]$$

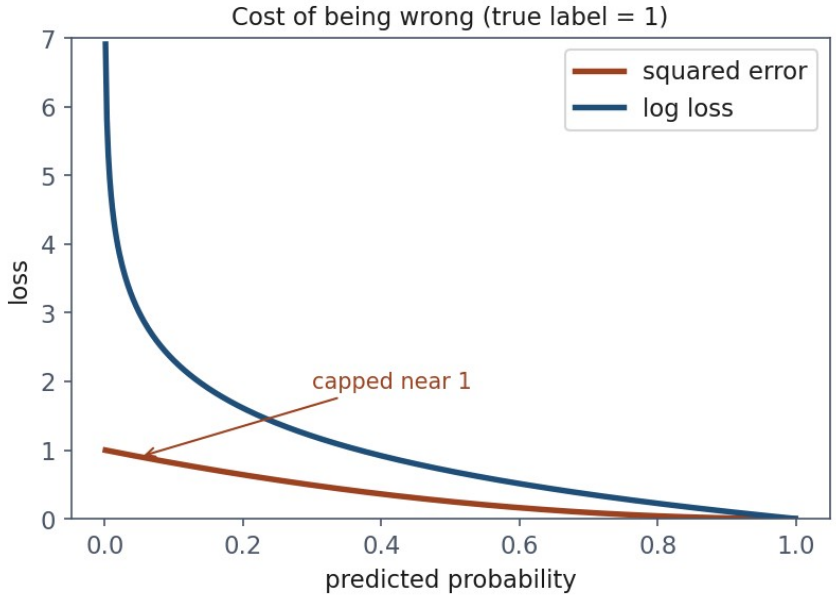
UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

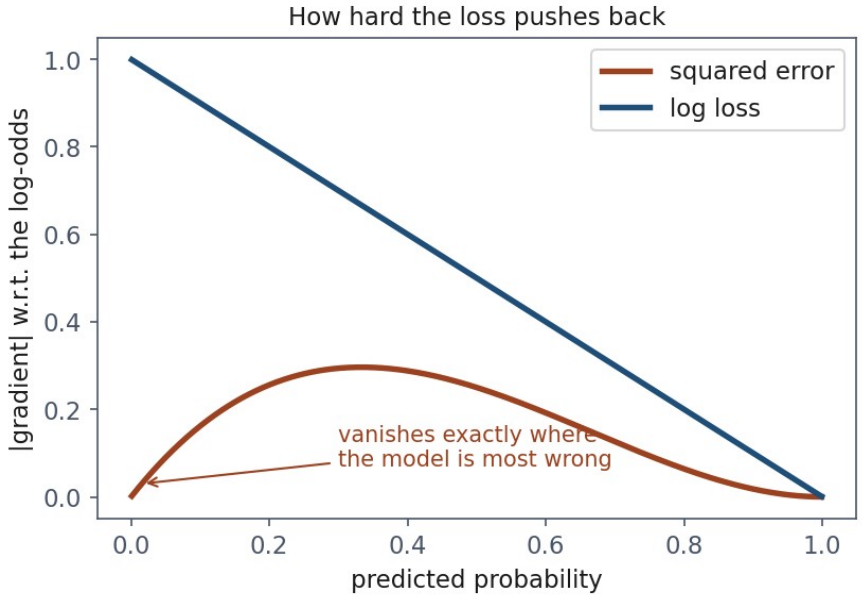
Lesson 3’s gradient, $\hat{y} = \sigma(w^T x + b)$

$$\frac{\partial J}{\partial w_j} = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^{m} (\hat{y}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) x_j^{(i)}$$

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

So why not squared error?





UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

And it is convex, which squared error is not

- Log loss is **convex** in the weights, so any local minimum is global
- Squared error through a sigmoid is not

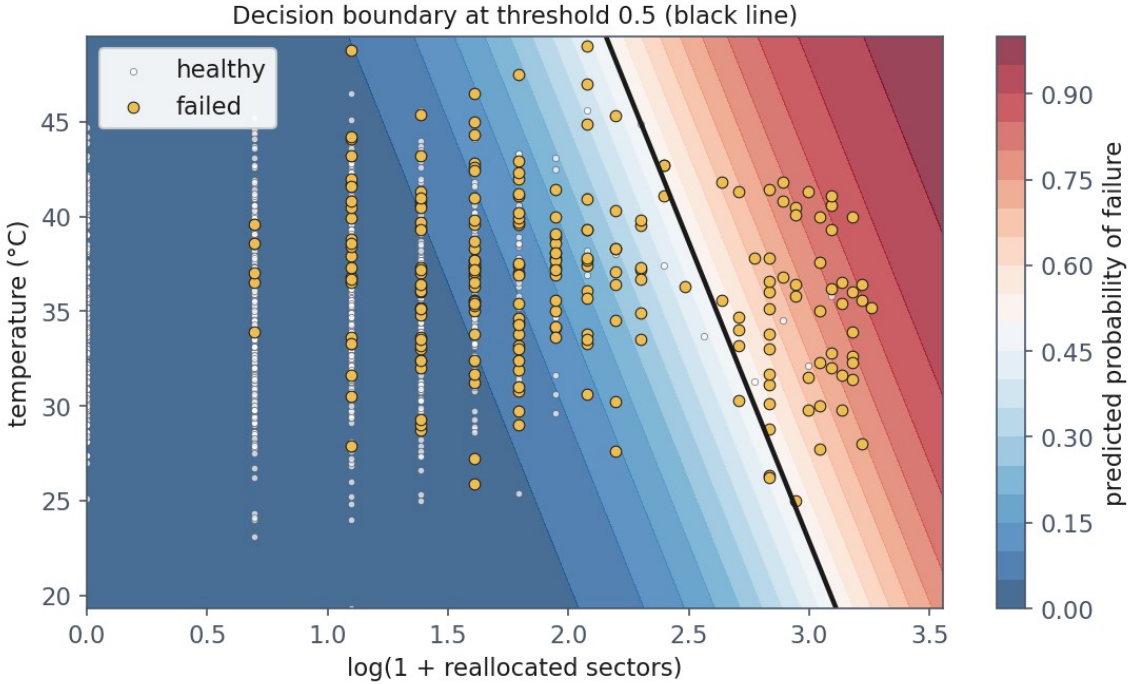
UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Notebook 1, live

section, and its slides	you call (→ the number to come back with)
a line on a 0/1 label, 7	`LinearRegression` → 3,606 negative probabilities
odds, and why not squared error, 8-25	NumPy only: the sigmoid, the two losses, their gradients
gradient descent, 23	`train_test_split`, `StandardScaler`, fifteen lines of NumPy → log loss 0.6931 to 0.0692
the decision boundary, 27	`make_pipeline(StandardScaler(), LogisticRegression())` on two features
the truth, recovered, 14-15	`LogisticRegression`, `.coef_`, `.intercept_` → seek_error_rate 0.02, intercept −6.09

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The decision boundary



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Break

- Ten minutes

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Two models

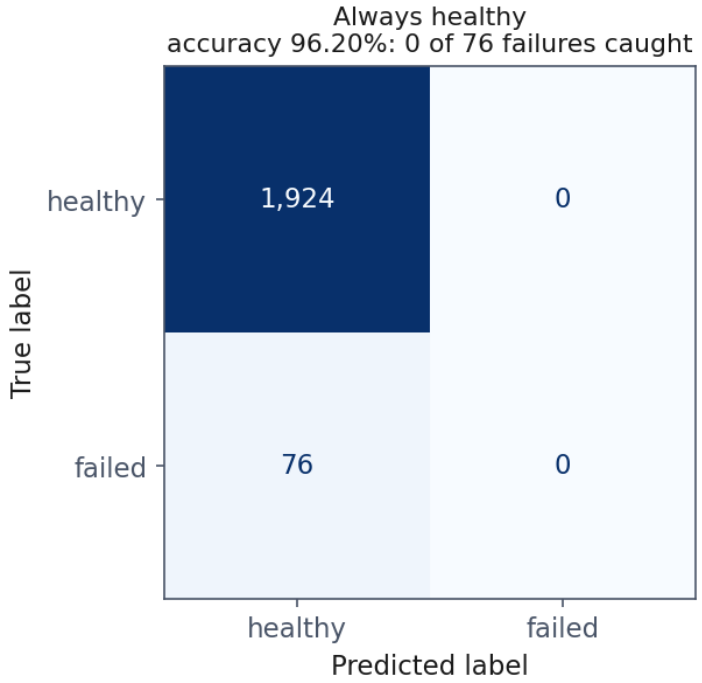
Model, on the 2,000 test drives (76 fail)	Accuracy = right ÷ 2,000	Failures caught
Predict “healthy” for everything	every healthy drive: 1,924 ÷ 2,000 = **96.20%**	**0 of 76**
Logistic regression, threshold 0.5	43 failures + 1,911 healthy: 1,954 ÷ 2,000 = 97.70%	43 of 76

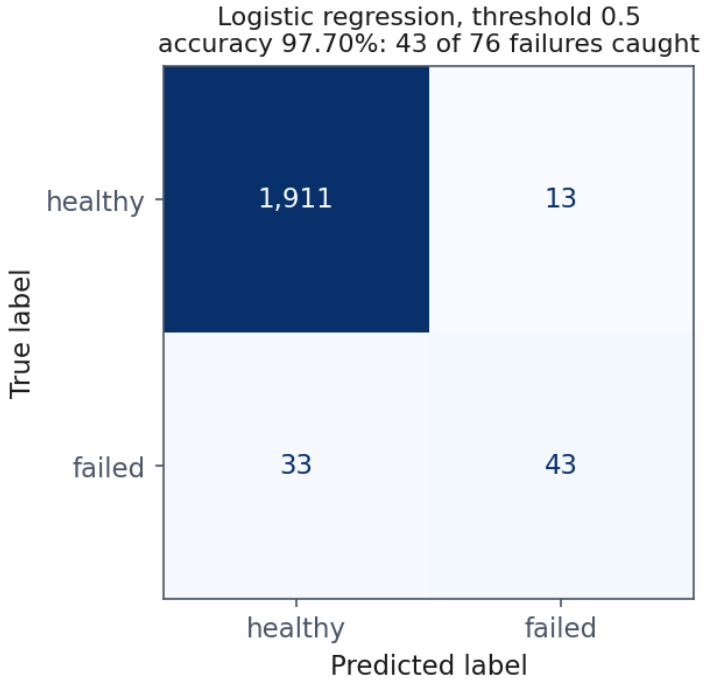
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Why everyone makes this mistake once

- Accuracy is the fraction of predictions that were right
- On a **balanced** problem that is exactly what you want
- The interesting class is almost always the **rare** one

Four numbers instead of one





UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The four outcomes, and what they cost

- **False positive**: we replace a healthy drive. A technician’s hour, €140
- **False negative**: a drive dies in service. Callout, rebuild, risk, €2,600
- Both costs are assumptions supplied from outside the data, not measured

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Precision and recall: look at the denominator

Precision = TP / (TP + FP)
"of the alarms we raised"

	predicted healthy	predicted failing
actually healthy	TN 1911	**FP** 13
actually failed	FN 33	**TP** 43

Recall = TP / (TP + FN)
"of the drives that failed"

	predicted healthy	predicted failing
actually healthy	TN 1911	FP 13
actually failed	**FN** 33	**TP** 43

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Our model, in those terms

- True and false positives and negatives: TP, FP, FN, TN
- Precision = TP ÷ (TP + FP) = 43 ÷ (43 + 13) = **0.768**: of the drives flagged
- Recall = TP ÷ (TP + FN) = 43 ÷ (43 + 33) = **0.566**: of the drives that failed
- Specificity = TN ÷ (TN + FP) = 1,911 ÷ (1,911 + 13) = 0.993
- In code: `precision_score`, `recall_score`

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

F1: why the harmonic mean

Model	Precision	Recall	Arithmetic mean	Harmonic, F1 = 2PR ÷ (P + R)
Flag every drive	76 ÷ 2,000 = 0.038	76 ÷ 76 = 1	(0.038 + 1) ÷ 2 = 0.519	2 × 0.038 × 1 ÷ 1.038 = **0.073**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

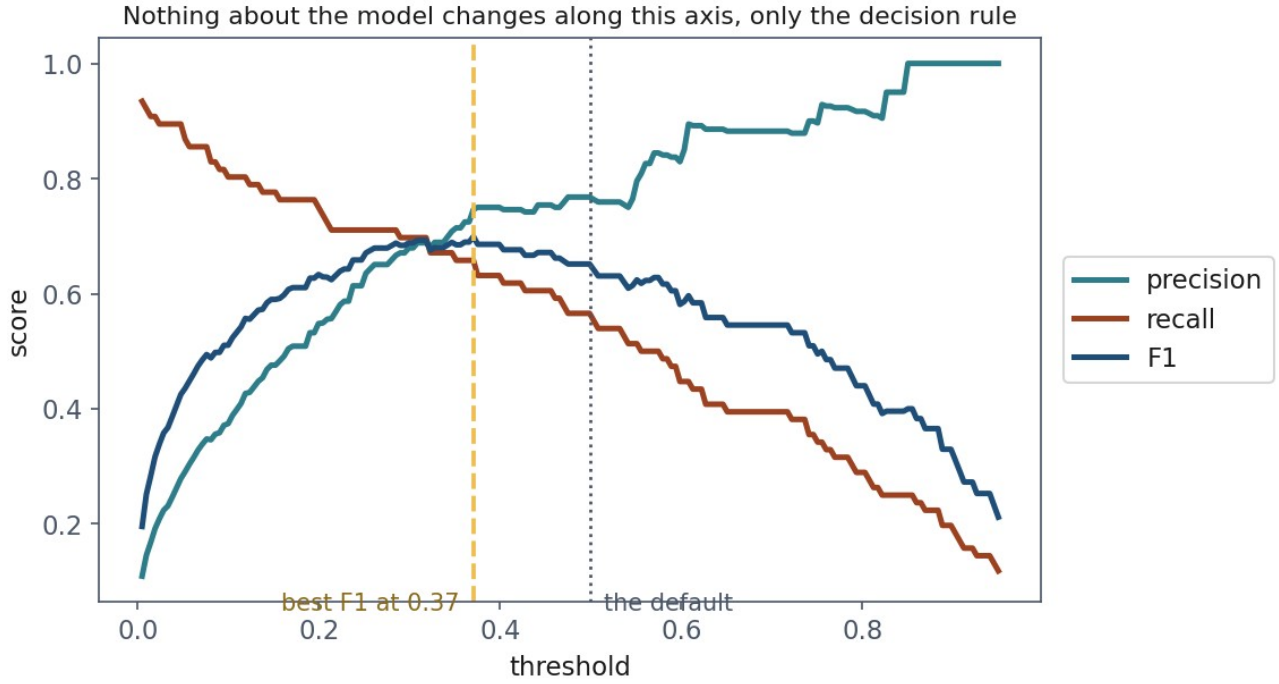
Read the minority class, not the average

- F1 per class: healthy 0.988 (1,924 drives), failed 0.652 (76 drives)
- `macro avg` F1 = (0.988 + 0.652) ÷ 2 = **0.820**: both classes count the same
- `weighted avg` F1 = (1,924 × 0.988 + 76 × 0.652) ÷ 2,000 = **0.975**: the healthy class dominates
- In code: `classification_report(y_test, y_pred)` prints both rows

Notebook 2, live

section, and its slides	you call (→ the number to come back with)
the number that should worry you, 29	`accuracy_score` → 96.20% for “always healthy”
the confusion matrix, 31	counts by hand, then `confusion_matrix`, `ConfusionMatrixDisplay` → TP 43
precision and recall, 33-36	`precision_score`, `recall_score`, `f1_score`, `classification_report`
the threshold sweep, 38-39	`predict_proba`, then the metrics at each threshold
the precision-recall curve, 40	`precision_recall_curve`, `average_precision_score` → 0.717 against 0.038

The threshold is a choice nobody made



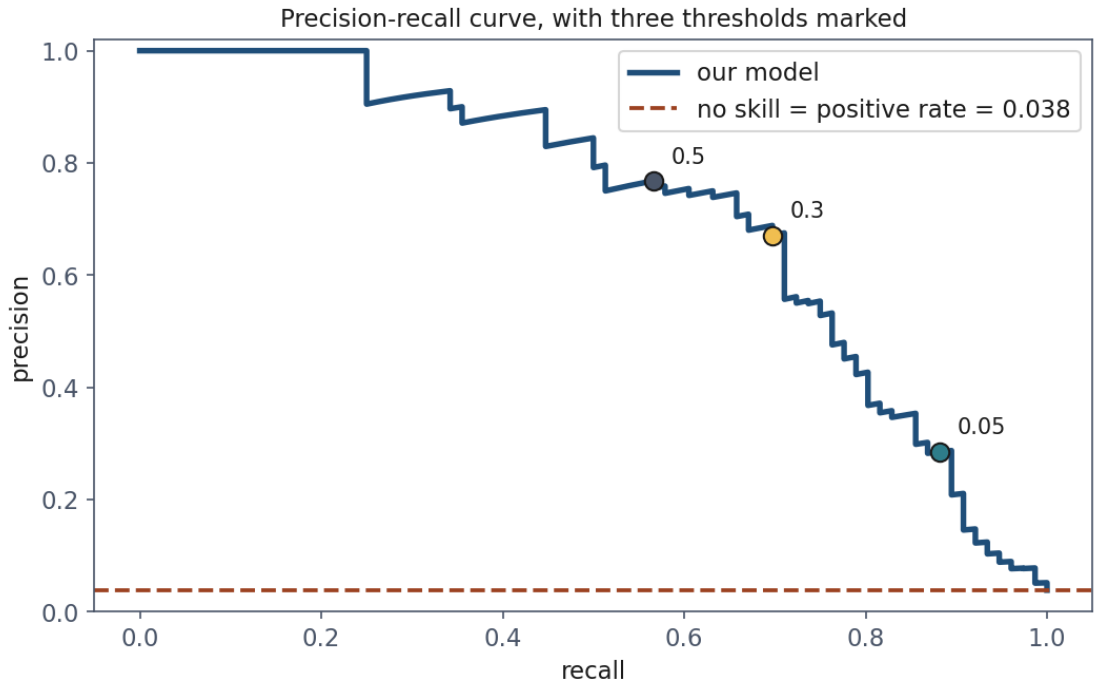
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

What the sweep actually costs

Threshold	TP	FP	FN	Precision, TP ÷ (TP + FP)	Recall, TP ÷ (TP + FN)	Accuracy, (TP + TN) ÷ 2,000
0.02	69	284	7	0.195	0.908	0.855
0.10	61	102	15	0.374	0.803	0.942
0.30	53	25	23	0.679	0.697	0.976
0.50	43	13	33	0.768	0.566	**0.977**
0.90	14	0	62	1.000	0.184	0.969

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The precision-recall curve



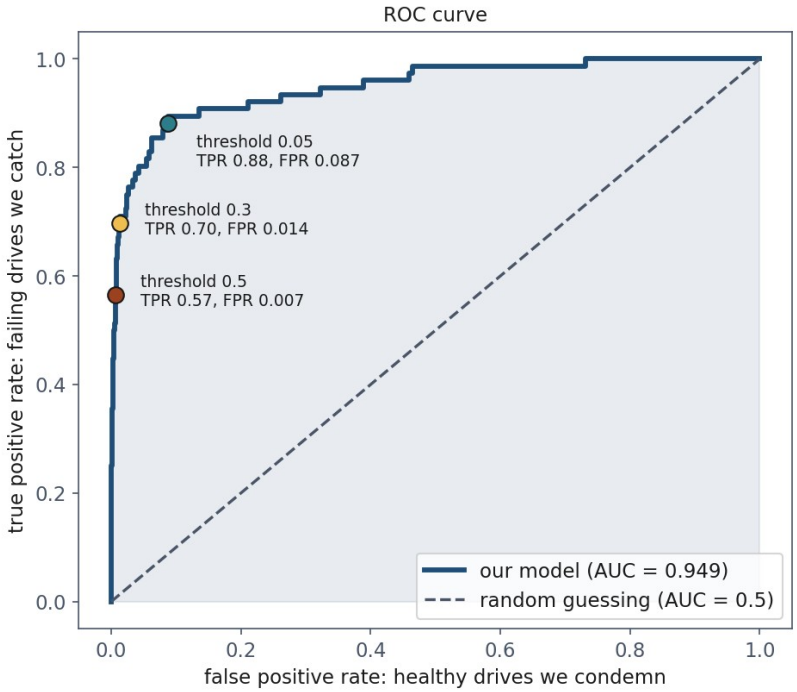
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Comparing models without choosing a threshold

- We keep evaluating at one threshold, but which?
- What if we score the whole **ranking** instead?

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The ROC curve



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

What the area means

- **Area under the curve (AUC) = the probability that a random failing drive scores above a random healthy one**
- Ours: 0.949 (`roc_auc_score`, notebook 3)
- Check: in 200,000 random pairs, the failing drive scores higher 94.9% of the time
- In code: `roc_auc_score(y_test, scores)`

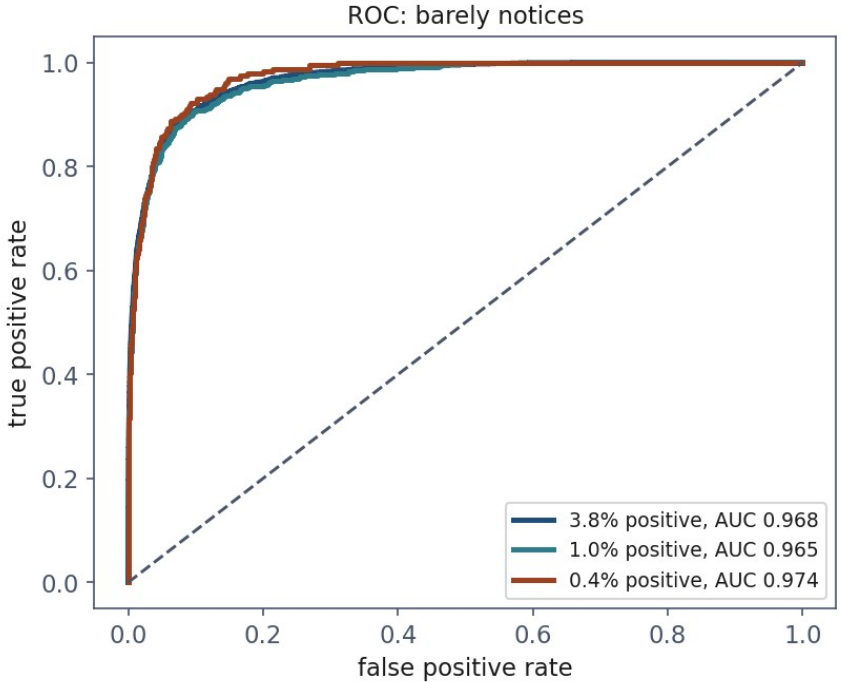
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

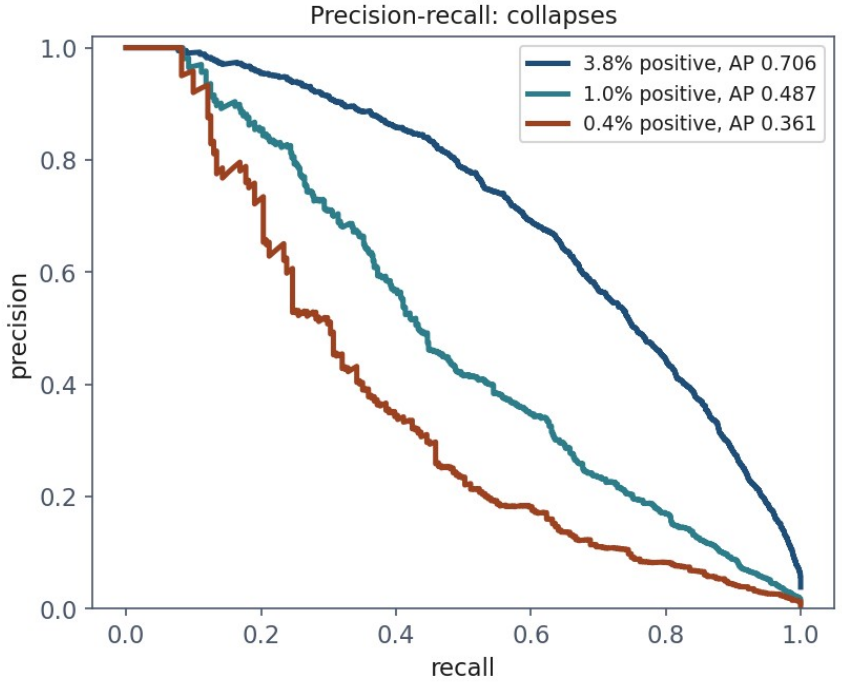
What AUC does not tell you

- Divide every predicted probability by 10
- AUC is **unchanged**; every decision changes

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

Where ROC misleads





UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Why the two disagree

- False positive rate (FPR) divides by **all healthy drives**: an enormous, growing denominator
- Precision divides by **the alarms raised**, where the false ones dominate

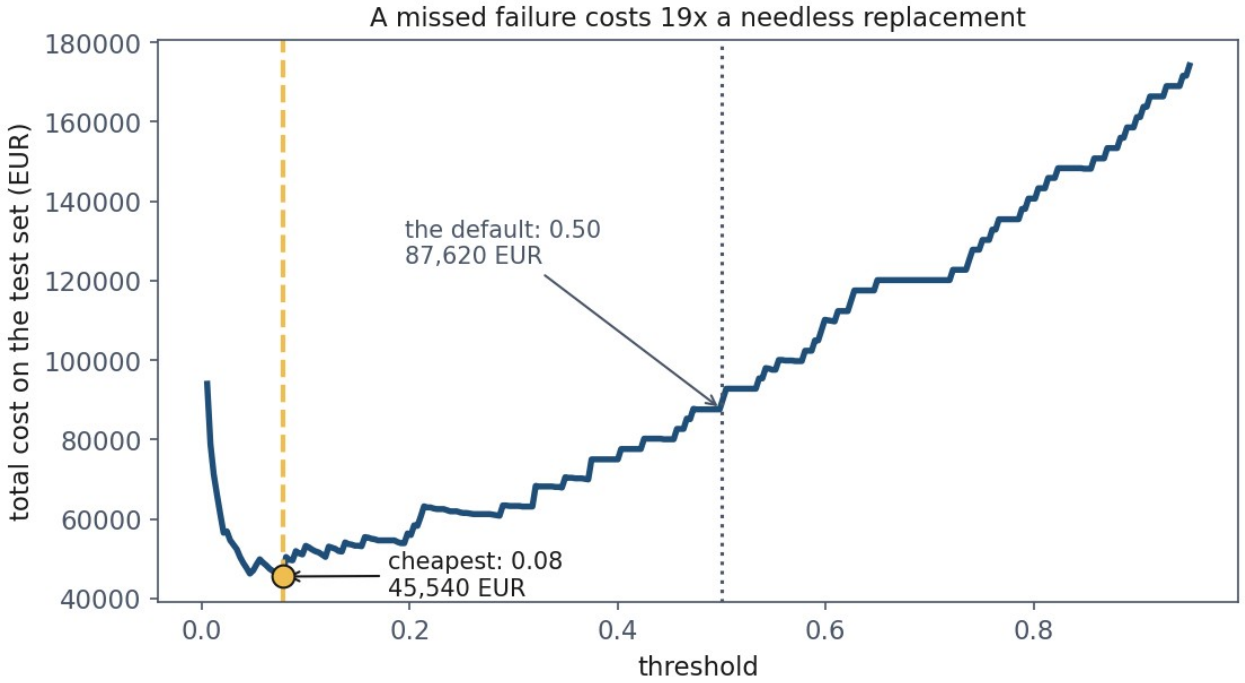
UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

The rule

- On an imbalanced problem, report the **precision-recall curve alongside AUC**
- Never instead of it, and never AUC alone
- Its area is the **average precision**, `average_precision_score`: 0.717 here, against 0.038 = 76 ÷ 2,000 for a model that ranks at random

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Choosing the threshold from money



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

And it has a closed form

$$t^* = \frac{C_{FP}}{C_{FP} + C_{FN}} = \frac{140}{140 + 2600} = 0.051$$

UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DELL'AQUILA

The caveat you must state

- We chose the threshold **by looking at the test set**
- That is precisely what lesson 1 forbade

Class weights: the same lever, pulled earlier

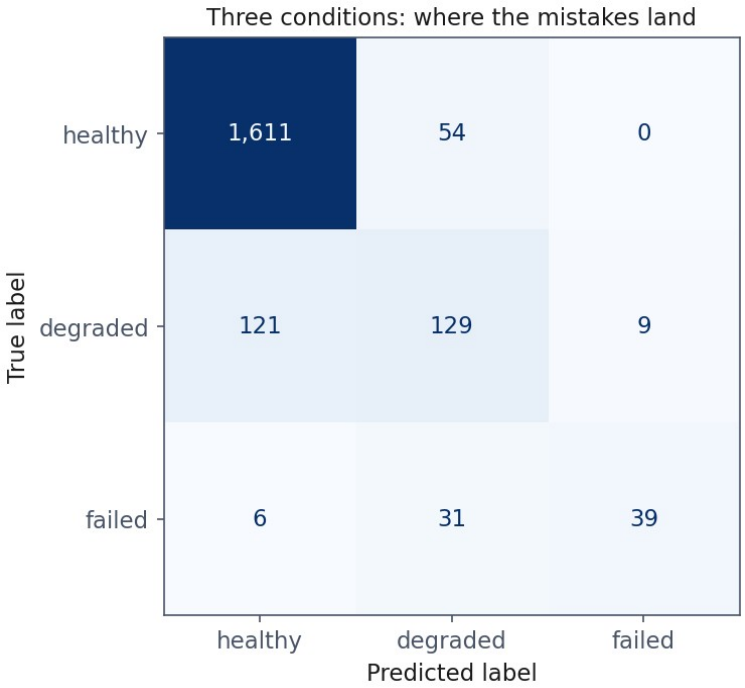
Model	Failures missed, FN	False alarms, FP	Cost = FN × €2,600 + FP × €140	AUC
Plain, threshold 0.50	33	13	33 × 2,600 + 13 × 140 = €87,620	0.949
Plain, threshold 0.08	11	121	11 × 2,600 + 121 × 140 = €45,540	0.949
Balanced class weights, 0.50	8	205	8 × 2,600 + 205 × 140 = €49,500	**0.950**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Notebook 3, live

section, and its slides	you call (→ the number to come back with)
the ROC curve by hand, 42	`roc_curve`, `roc_auc_score` → 0.9493
what AUC means, 43	200,000 random (failing, healthy) pairs → 0.9488
the rare-positive trap, 45-46	`average_precision_score` beside `roc_auc_score` → AP 0.706 to 0.361, AUC unmoved
the threshold from costs, 48-50	`confusion_matrix` at each threshold → 45,540 EUR at 0.08, against 87,620 at 0.50
class weights, 51	`LogisticRegression` with balanced class weights → AUC 0.950
three classes, 53-54	`classification_report` → macro F1 0.707, weighted 0.883

More than two classes



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Macro against weighted, one last time

- F1 per class: healthy 0.947 (1,665 drives), degraded 0.545 (259), failed 0.629 (76)
- macro avg F1 = (0.947 + 0.545 + 0.629) ÷ 3 = **0.707**
- weighted avg F1 = (1,665 × 0.947 + 259 × 0.545 + 76 × 0.629) ÷ 2,000 = **0.883**

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

What to take away

- **96.20% accuracy, nothing caught.** Accuracy measures the majority class
- Precision is about the **alarms**, recall is about the **failures**
- The **threshold is a decision**, and it has a formula
- **AUC measures ranking** and hides imbalance

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA

Homework

- **Exercise 4**, discussed at the start of **Friday 6 November**
- Build a classifier, choose a threshold from a stated cost ratio, defend it

UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DELL'AQUILA